



JIM THORPE LOSES HIS MEDALS BUT WINS THEM BACK, POSTHUMOUSLY

The first native American to win an Olympic gold medal, Jim Thorpe, was stripped of his gold medals in the decathlon and pentathlon events by the Olympic Committee. It was found he had been paid for playing two seasons of semi-professional baseball before competing in the Olympics — a practice against the rules of amateurism of the Games back then.

In 1983, 30 years after his death, the International Olympic Committee (IOC) restored his Olympic medals with replicas, after ruling that the decision to strip him of his medals fell outside of the required 30 days.

GETTY IMAGES



THE FLYING FINN BANNED FROM COMPETING

In the 1932 Olympics held in Los Angeles, nine-time Finnish Olympic gold medallist Paavo Nurmi's amateur status was questioned by Swedish authorities and he was banned from running in the Games. Despite pleas from all the other competing athletes of the marathon, he was not allowed to compete. Nurmi was later forced into retirement due to this incident, making this one of the most shameful incidents in Olympic history.

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